

Karen Zheng

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EDUCATION

New York University, Tisch School of the Arts

New York, NY

BFA in Interactive Media Arts | GPA: 3.81

May 2028

Certifications: EA Product Management Simulation (Forage), IBM AI & AI Interaction (SkillsBuild)

Professional Development: Management Leadership for Tomorrow (MLT, Corporate Management Track)

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

DuKode Studio | *UX Research Internship* | New York, NY

Jun 2026 – Present

- Conducted competitive analysis of 18 fintech and digital banking products
- Identified 40+ UX patterns and feature opportunities that informed product strategy
- Lead, analyzed and coded 5+ interview transcripts that lead to 300+ participant quotes
- Synthesized 150+ affinity notes, and identified 12 recurring research themes that informed product requirements

Urban Arts, Game Academy | *Ambassador* | New York, NY

Sep 2025 – Present

- Presented to 100+ students using user-focused communication and audience-tailored messaging
- Collaborated with 20+ team members to improve engagement and program experience consistency

Urban Arts, Game Academy | *Teacher Assistant* | New York, NY

Sep 2024 – Present

- Taught 155+ students game design, interaction logic, and C# in Unity,
- Used quantitative performance metrics and qualitative feedback, increasing student retention by 21%
- Designed structured learning experiences, achieving 98% completion rate (+37% YoY)
- Facilitated 70+ one-on-one tutoring covering interaction design and user-centered design principles

PROJECTS

OneHandler | *Human-Centered Design, Physical Prototyping*

Nov 2025 – Dec 2025

- Conducted 8+ user interviews, contextual observations, and 3 competitor analyses
- Iterated 5+ prototype iterations, refining the solution through research-driven design decisions
- Delivered a 100% recyclable physical prototype that translated user research insights into a sustainable product solution focused on usability, accessibility, and waste reduction

Altrovia Website Redesign (Designathon) | *Information Architecture*

Apr 2025

- Conducted competitive analysis of 8 healthcare and tech websites to identify patterns in product storytelling
- Collaborated with a 3-person team in a 48-hour design hackathon to redesign Altrovia's website and improve communication of its AI-powered clinical trial platform
- Created 7+ wireframes and high-fidelity prototypes to simplify complex AI concepts

Color Clash | *p5.js, Aseprite, After Effects*

Nov 2025 – Dec 2025

- Designed interactive user flows and wireframes for a browser-based application
- Built a component-based UI system with real-time input handling and state-based interactions
- Tested and iterated interface design to achieve smooth 60 FPS performance (90%+ speech recognition)

Future Innovators Summit (Hosted by Comcast NBCUniversal) | *Google Slides, Procreate*

Nov 2025

- Worked in a 5-person team in a 150+ participant design sprint to improve user experience
- Designed a wayfinding system featuring real-time wait times and exploration flows for Universal Epic Universe

The Vanishing Enigma | *Unity, Visual Studio, C#, Aseprite*

Aug 2023 – June 2024

- Contributed to 10-person game with 400+ players and 600+ views on itch.io
- Designed 15+ character assets supporting end-to-end game development
- Winner of 2024 Congressional App Challenge (12,682 submissions)

SKILLS

Coding: C#, Python, JavaScript, p5.js, Java, HTML, CSS

Design & Tools: Figma, Unity, Adobe Creative Suite, Aseprite, Visual Studio, Google Suite, Adobe After Effects